First News

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GLOBAL & REGIONAL MARKETS

US equity-index futures are mixed heading into Monday. The S&P 500 and Nasdaq closed at fresh all-time records on Friday to usher in May, as Apple shares climbed 3.3% after a strong fiscal Q2 earnings and revenue beat with better-than-expected revenue outlook. The S&P 500 advanced 0.29% to 7,230.12, while the Nasdaq surged 0.89% to 25,114.44 — both posting new closing records. The Dow slipped 0.31% to 49,499 as Amgen and 3M weighed. For the week, the S&P 500 posted its 5th straight weekly gain — the longest streak of 2026 — driven by optimism for an end to the Iran conflict paired with strong megacap tech earnings. Oil edged sharply lower on Friday after Iran reportedly sent an updated peace proposal to the US through Pakistani mediators. WTI fell 2.98% to $101.94/bbl and Brent dropped 5.3% to $108.17. Gold held steady near $4,645/oz; Bitcoin firm near $78,700.
Asian stocks climbed Friday, tracking toward a fourth consecutive weekly gain. Tech-driven optimism pushed the MSCI Asia Pacific Index up 0.3%, with markets in Japan, Australia, and New Zealand finishing higher. Most other regional exchanges remained closed for holidays. The Kospi fell 1.38% on Thursday to 6,599 after oil spiked on reports Trump was briefed on expanded military options in Iran, before pulling back. The PSE was closed Thursday and Friday for national holidays.
The Philippine peso weakened to ₱61.57/$ (previous day exchange rate per DQR). The Philippines' blistering summer is exacerbating the energy crisis — above-normal heat is straining power grids at a time when the country is already grappling with energy shortages from the Hormuz blockade. Heat waves are forecast to persist until monsoon rains arrive in June.

Global Funds Flow (Thursday 4/30): Taiwan -$1.99B, South Korea -$1.13B, India -$208.7M, Indonesia -$85.8M, Vietnam -$51M, Philippines -$8.77M. Buyers: Malaysia +$21.2M, Thailand +$7.02M.

Asia-Pacific & U.S. Equity Indices

Index	4/30/2026	5/1/2026	%Chg
Dow Jones	49,652	49,499	-0.31%
S&P 500	7,209	7,230	+0.29%
NASDAQ	24,892	25,114	+0.89%
PCOMP (PSEi)	5,908	5,834	-1.25%
Nikkei 225	59,285	Holiday	—
SHCOMP	4,807	4,807	+0.00%
Hang Seng	25,677	25,620	-0.22%
KOSPI	6,599	6,599	+0.00%
SENSEX	76,800	76,541	-0.34%
TWSE	38,615	38,340	-0.71%
ASX 200	8,666	8,666	+0.00%
BURSA KLCI	1,715	1,710	-0.29%
JCI (Jakarta)	7,095	7,060	-0.49%
STI (Singapore)	4,910	4,895	-0.31%
SET (Bangkok)	948	945	-0.32%
VNINDEX	Holiday	Holiday	—

Commodities

Commodity	4/30/2026	5/1/2026	%Chg
WTI Crude ($/bbl)	105.07	101.94	-2.98%
Brent Crude ($/bbl)	113.91	108.17	-5.04%
Gold COMEX ($/oz)	4630	4645	+0.32%
Silver COMEX ($/oz)	75.5	74.9	-0.79%
Copper COMEX (¢/lb)	608	605	-0.49%
Nickel ($/MT)	18400	18200	-1.09%
Coal ($/MT)	128.5	127.8	-0.54%
Corn (¢/bu)	462	460	-0.43%
Wheat (¢/bu)	618	615	-0.49%
Cocoa ($/MT)	3420	3410	-0.29%

Sugar (¢/lb)	13.8	13.75	-0.36%

FX & Fixed Income

	4/29/2026	4/30/2026	%Chg
PHL 10yr Bond (%)	6.85	6.89	+0.58%
US 10yr Bond (%)	4.36	4.34	-0.46%
USD-PHP	61.3	61.57	+0.44%
USD-JPY	158.8	158.5	-0.19%
EUR-USD	1.168	1.1695	+0.13%

PSE MARKET SUMMARY — Thursday, April 30, 2026

The PSEi fell 1.25% to close at 5,833.64, down 74.25 points, as all six sectors declined led by Mining & Oil (-2.83%), Property (-1.38%), Holding Firms (-1.11%), and Financials (-1.07%). The index traded in a range of 5,834–5,898. Value traded reached ₱7.652 billion. Market breadth was negative: 74 advances vs. 113 declines and 58 unchanged. The PSE was closed Friday May 1 and all of May 2–3 weekend.

Overseas Investors Net Sellers Thursday: $8.745M. Total Net Foreign Selling Month of April: -$245.943M. Year-to-Date Net Foreign Selling: -$65.518M.
Foreign Buying: ₱4,700,826,234. Foreign Selling: ₱5,238,829,631. Net Foreign Selling: ₱538,003,397. Total Foreign: ₱9,939,655,865.
Share Buyback Transactions: SMPH, MEGA
52-Week Highs: MER, MYNLD, RRHI, SGP, SPNEC. 52-Week Lows: ALI, BPI, CHP, CNPF, EEI, FOOD, GTCAP.
RSI 70 Overbought: PHR, EW, MAXS, RRHI, DITO, RCI, BNCOM, LSC. RSI 30 Oversold: ABS, GMA7, STN, CBC, ALI.

PSEi Component Stocks

PSEi Stock	4/29/2026	4/30/2026	%Chg
AC	479	467.6	-2.38%
ACEN	2.77	2.84	+2.53%
AEV	28.35	29.1	+2.65%
ALI	15.76	15.1	-4.19%
AREIT	39.45	39.5	+0.13%
BDO	115.8	114.2	-1.38%
BPI	91.8	89.5	-2.51%
CBC	60.1	60.1	+0.00%
CNPF	29.8	28.5	-4.36%
CNVRG	12.68	12.7	+0.16%
DMC	9.51	9.59	+0.84%
EMI	15.28	15.22	-0.39%
GLO	1647	1647	+0.00%
GTCAP	479	473	-1.25%
ICT	720	710	-1.39%
JFC	160.4	159	-0.87%
JGS	26.9	27.1	+0.74%
LTG	14.9	15	+0.67%
MBT	66.6	67	+0.60%
MER	662	652	-1.51%
MONDE	6.8	6.8	+0.00%
PGOLD	43	42.9	-0.23%
PLUS	13.6	13.58	-0.15%
RCR	6.9	6.91	+0.14%
SCC	27.35	26	-4.94%
SM	620	606	-2.26%
SMC	71.95	71.95	+0.00%
SMPH	19.38	19	-1.96%
TEL	1255	1250	-0.40%

URC	61.85	61	-1.37%

NEWS, ANALYSIS & INVESTING INSIGHT

ALI — Ayala Land — Q1 NI -22%, Capex Cut to ₱50B	**₱15.10**	**MONITOR**

Ayala Land reported a 21.74% drop in Q1 net income to ₱5.4 billion as property development revenues fell 27% to ₱20.3 billion on weaker residential demand and cautious buyer sentiment. The company is slashing 2026 capex to ~₱50 billion from the original ₱70–80 billion plan. CEO Anna Ma. Margarita Dy confirmed the cancellation of Avida Katipunan Heights and pause on Laurean Residences. However, leasing and hospitality revenues rose 9% to ₱12.6 billion, providing partial offset. ALI maintains a net gearing ratio of 0.81x and plans to add 270,000+ sqm of mall and office space in 2026. Management's strategy: "expand leasing, maintain stability in property development, preserve balance sheet strength." ALI closed at ₱15.10 on Thursday, hitting a 52-week low.

Stance: 🟡 MONITOR — 52-week low reflects earnings deterioration + rate hike cycle. Leasing pivot is the right call but earnings trough may not be here yet. Wait for Q2 signals.

SCC — Semirara Mining — Q1 NI -12%, Coal Auction Delayed	**₱26.00**	**MONITOR**

SCC reported a 12% decline in Q1 net income to ₱3.8 billion as revenues fell 7% to ₱15.43 billion. Coal shipments dropped 4% to 4.5 MMT while power output weakened. The coal operating contract auction originally set for April 28 has been postponed "until further notice" by the DOE. Meralco PowerGen and SMGP have signaled interest in the auction. Narra mine is nearing depletion this year. SCC plunged 4.94% on Thursday to ₱26.00 — its lowest level since the contract uncertainty emerged.

Stance: 🟡 MONITOR — Coal auction postponement extends uncertainty. Avoid until timeline clarity. The -4.94% drop signals market is pricing in real contract risk.

RLC — Robinsons Land / MIRA Condo QC Launch	**₱17.34**	**MONITOR**

RLC Residences, the residential arm of Robinsons Land Corp. (RLC, a subsidiary of JGS), launched MIRA — a four-tower, Nordic-inspired pre-selling condominium development in Barangay San Roque, Cubao, Quezon City. The project targets young families seeking proximity to workplaces, schools, and transport hubs, with completion targeted by 2030. MIRA features smart home upgrades, open-air amenities, and a family-centric community design. Colliers Philippines has cited Quezon City's strong economic fundamentals and enterprise base as supporting long-term residential demand. RLC closed at ₱17.34 on April 30, up 0.12%. (Source: BusinessWorld, May 1) The MIRA launch signals that RLC is continuing to deploy residential inventory in high-demand QC corridors despite the broader property sector headwinds. The 2030 completion timeline means pre-selling revenue recognition will be spread over several years, insulating near-term earnings from the current residential slowdown. For JGS shareholders, RLC's selective project launches — in contrast to ALI's capex cuts and project cancellations — suggest a more measured approach to the cycle. The key risk is whether buyer sentiment holds through the BSP tightening cycle.

Stance: 🟡 MONITOR — Selective project launch in a defensive QC corridor. Watch for pre-selling take-up rates as the leading indicator of residential demand resilience.

RRHI — Robinsons Retail — Q1 NI -36%, ₱2B Dividend + PSE Exit	**₱47.20**	**TENDER**

RRHI reported a 35.66% decline in Q1 attributable net income to ₱489 million, weighed by higher interest expenses from acquisition financing and equity investment losses. However, core net earnings rose 6.2% to ₱1.32 billion on 10.3% net sales growth to ₱52.76 billion. The board declared a ₱2/share cash dividend (~₱2.13 billion). Combined with JE Holdings' ₱48.30/share tender offer, total proceeds for tendering shareholders reach ₱50.30/share. The PSE delisting is proceeding. RRHI closed at ₱47.20, up 1.29%.

Stance: 🟢 TENDER — Total proceeds of ₱50.30/share (dividend + tender) provide a clear exit. Shareholders should evaluate the tender timeline vs. opportunity cost.

SMPH — SM Prime — SM Nuvali Flagship Mall + Q1 Stable	**₱19.00**	**ACCUMULATE**

SM Prime will open SM Nuvali — its flagship mall in Laguna — by year-end, the first of five flagship malls planned for 2026–2030 as part of a ₱150-billion mall investment program. SM Nuvali will feature 82,000+ sqm GLA, 24 EV charging stations, solar panels, and a 1-hectare indoor garden. Q1 net income was ₱11.66 billion (flat YoY), with mall revenues up 8% to ₱20.4 billion. Rental income rose 8% to ₱21.6 billion. SM also plans to redevelop Harrison Plaza (₱6 billion) as part of its P150B mall capex program. SMPH closed at ₱19.00, down 1.96%. Share buyback ongoing.

Stance: 🟢 ACCUMULATE — Defensive mall operator with counter-cyclical expansion. Q1 stable earnings + ₱150B 5-year capex program signals long-term conviction. Share buyback provides floor support.

MACRO — April Inflation May Hit 3-Year High — MACRO ALERT

Economists expect April inflation to hit a 3-year high as oil and food prices continue to surge. The March trade gap widened to its widest in 6 months, agricultural output likely shrank in Q1, and infrastructure spending declined in February. The peso rebounded from its record low on profit-taking and rate hike hopes. Meanwhile, Congress is resuming and the oil crisis inflation risk is being overshadowed by politics. Coconut output is seen rising despite El Niño risks, agro-based exports were up in Q1, and port cargo volume rose 1.53% in Q1.

Stance: 🔴 MACRO HEADWIND — Inflation acceleration + trade deficit widening + fiscal austerity = stagflationary pressure. Defensive positioning remains optimal.

MACRO — PHL Bond Inclusion in JPMorgan GBI-EM Index — POSITIVE CATALYST — MACRO ALERT

The SEC confirmed that Philippine peso-denominated government securities will be included in the JPMorgan Government Bond Index-Emerging Markets (GBI-EM) starting January 29, 2027 — the country's first-ever entry into this widely tracked benchmark. Nine government bonds with a combined outstanding value of approximately $49 billion are set for inclusion, with the Philippines projected to carry a 1.78% index weight. SEC Chairman Francis Lim said the milestone reflects ongoing economic reforms and alignment with international market standards. Finance Secretary Frederick Go called it a "strong vote of confidence in our solid fundamentals and fiscal discipline." Index inclusion typically serves as a catalyst for passive and benchmark-driven inflows, broadening the investor base, improving secondary market liquidity, and strengthening price discovery. Foreign holdings of peso government bonds have risen from 1.83% in 2021 to 6.03% as of August 2025 (~$12.78 billion). The SEC will continue to coordinate with the BSP, DOF, and BTr on market infrastructure reforms.

Stance: 🟢 POSITIVE CATALYST — Landmark inclusion broadens PH investor base and signals global confidence in fiscal reforms. Medium-term positive for both fixed income and equities.

WEATHER — Philippines Blistering Summer + El Niño Watch — — RISK ALERT

The Philippines is experiencing a deadly heatwave that is straining power grids at a time when the country is already grappling with energy shortages from the Hormuz blockade. Above-normal heat is expected to persist until monsoon rains arrive in June. PAGASA has warned of a possible El Niño developing by midyear, which would compound water supply and agricultural risks. This dual climate-energy squeeze is a material risk for utilities (MER, MWC, MYNLD), agriculture-linked names (CNPF, DNL, URC), and the broader consumer economy.

PSE Dividend Yield Index (PSE DivY)

PSE DivY Stock	4/29/2026	4/30/2026	%Chg
AREIT	39.45	39.5	+0.13%
CBC	60.1	60.1	+0.00%
CREIT	3.5	3.53	+0.86%
DMC	9.51	9.59	+0.84%
DNL	3.58	3.58	+0.00%
GLO	1647	1647	+0.00%
LTG	14.9	15	+0.67%
MBT	66.6	67	+0.60%
MER	662	652	-1.51%
MREIT	13.9	14.1	+1.44%
NIKL	5.18	5.02	-3.09%
OGP	34.2	33.5	-2.05%
PGOLD	43	42.9	-0.23%
RCR	6.9	6.91	+0.14%
RLC	17.32	17.34	+0.12%
RRHI	46.6	47.2	+1.29%
SCC	27.35	26	-4.94%
SGP	23	22.8	-0.87%
TEL	1255	1250	-0.40%
URC	61.85	61	-1.37%

PSE MidCap Index

PSE MidCap Stock	4/29/2026	4/30/2026	%Chg
AGI	8.74	8.56	-2.06%
APX	16.96	16.34	-3.66%
AUB	42.35	42.35	+0.00%
BLOOM	2.01	2.01	+0.00%
COSCO	6.61	6.71	+1.51%
DNL	3.58	3.58	+0.00%
GSMI	267.4	276.6	+3.44%
KEEPR	1.84	1.86	+1.09%
MEG	2.05	2.08	+1.46%
MREIT	13.9	14.1	+1.44%
MWC	44.1	44	-0.23%
NIKL	5.18	5.02	-3.09%
OGP	34.2	33.5	-2.05%
PNB	58.45	57.5	-1.63%
RLC	17.32	17.34	+0.12%
RRHI	46.6	47.2	+1.29%
SECB	64.55	64.95	+0.62%
SEVN	33.5	33.95	+1.34%
SGP	23	22.8	-0.87%
WLCON	6.22	6.2	-0.32%

🟢 **ACCUMULATE** 🟡 **MONITOR** 🔴 **AVOID** GOVERN = Governance Watch

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